

Xiaomi Redmi Smart Fire TV 43-inch (L43R8-FVIN)

A well-rounded choice

₹24,990

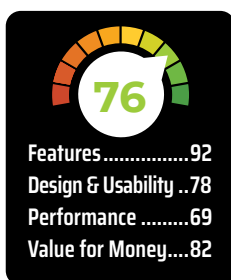


Xiaomi recently introduced a bigger Fire TV, the Redmi Smart Fire TV 4K 43, right in time for the Diwali festival season. This TV promises a sleek and modern design and also comes with Alexa integration to add to the smart home convenience. Does it deliver? Let's find out in our review.

DESIGN AND REMOTE

In terms of design, this 43-inch Fire TV looks like a mini version of the Xiaomi 65-inch X-series TV (2023) we recently reviewed. The TV features a functional design with narrow bezels on the sides and a metal frame for durability. There is an LED indicator and a button underneath for manual power control.

The plastic feet included in the box effectively stabilize the TV. The ports are situated on the centrally positioned rear



chassis, but the frequently used ports are side-facing and easily accessible. So, considering the price, we are perfectly satisfied with the design and build of the Redmi Smart Fire TV 4K 43.

Xiaomi also provides various connectivity options, including three HDMI ports on the rear. Xiaomi mentions that these are HDMI 2.1 ports with limited bandwidth. HDMI 2 supports eARC for higher bandwidth audio transmission to supported soundbars or other external audio systems.

The Alexa Remote that comes with Xiaomi's Fire TVs is a well-designed remote. It includes a mute button and dedicated media playback controls. These playback controls are handy when switching picture modes and controlling playback simultaneously. However, the forward and backward buttons didn't work with the side menu overlay on the

screen (the only time we needed them to). You can long-press the home button to access a quick settings menu on the right, offering options to switch inputs, change the picture mode, mirror the screen, and more. The good thing is that, compared to regular Xiaomi TV remotes, there is no confusing Patchwall key next to the home button.

Xiaomi also adds buttons to flip through channels and pull up channel guides for regular DTH TV. As for hot-keys, you have options for Netflix, Prime Video, Amazon Movies, and a shortcut to All Apps.

As you may have noticed, there are plenty of dedicated buttons on the remote that you might not use very frequently, but they are super convenient whenever you need to.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Fire OS 7 is a well-optimized interface, and during our review period, the performance felt snappier than Android TVs with similar configurations, i.e., 2GB of RAM and 8GB of storage. The Fire TV OS remains the same as what you'd find on other Fire TV devices, such as the Fire TV sticks or Fire TV Cube. Performance will vary according to the device's RAM and storage.

Personally, I find the Fire TV interface a lot more appealing and intuitive than Google TV. The menus are neatly arranged, making it easier to navigate to the options you are looking for. The TV also has AirPlay 2 support and you can cast videos seamlessly from both Apple iPhones and Android phones. For screen mirroring, the TV integrates Miracast.

Another advantage is the smart home functionality. Google Assistant and Alexa are widely recognized as the leading smart assistants for driving smart home features. Amazon has demonstrated a greater commitment to adapting and promoting its Echo devices in the Indian smart home market. As a result, Alexa has gained significant popularity among Indian smart home users, providing an advantage for Fire TV. For instance, as demonstrated by Xiaomi at a product